SQL

If I Have 0 Knowledge of SQL, This Is How I'd Get Job-Ready in 30 Days

A day-by-day 30-day plan from zero to interview-ready SQL. 1 to 1.5 hours a day. Each day has a topic and a practice task.

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- Week 4: Days 22 to 30
- Job-ready means you can do this

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Before day 1

Set this up once. It takes 30 minutes.

- **Pick one database**

  PostgreSQL (free) or MySQL. Do not switch midway.

- **Get a practice dataset**

  A sample sales or e-commerce database with customers, orders, products.

- **Rule for every day**

  Write every query yourself. Reading solutions does not count.

- **Keep a notebook**

  Every mistake and its fix. This becomes your revision sheet for interviews.

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Week 1: Days 1 to 7

Reading data. By day 7 you can answer simple business questions.

Day 1

SELECT, FROM, LIMIT. Task: show 10 orders with chosen columns.

Day 2

WHERE with =, >, <, AND, OR. Task: orders above ₹5,000 from Mumbai.

Day 3

IN, BETWEEN, LIKE, IS NULL. Task: customers with missing email.

Day 4

ORDER BY, DISTINCT. Task: list unique cities, sorted.

Day 5

COUNT, SUM, AVG, MIN, MAX. Task: total revenue and average order value.

Day 6

GROUP BY. Task: revenue by city.

Day 7

HAVING plus revision. Task: cities with more than 100 orders.

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Week 2: Days 8 to 14

Joins and logic. This is where most real work happens.

- **Day 8**

  INNER JOIN. Task: each order with customer name.

- **Day 9**

  LEFT JOIN. Task: all customers with their order count, including zero.

- **Day 10**

  Anti join (LEFT JOIN + IS NULL). Task: customers who never ordered.

- **Day 11**

  Joining 3 tables. Task: revenue by product category by city.

- **Day 12**

  CASE WHEN. Task: label orders Small, Medium, Large.

- **Day 13**

  Date functions. Task: revenue by month and by weekday.

- **Day 14**

  Revision. Solve 10 mixed questions without help.

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Week 3: Days 15 to 21

Intermediate SQL. This is what separates you in interviews.

- **Day 15**

  Subqueries. Task: orders above the average order value.

- **Day 16**

  CTEs (WITH). Task: rewrite day 15 as a CTE.

- **Day 17**

  ROW_NUMBER, RANK, DENSE_RANK. Task: top 3 products per category.

- **Day 18**

  Running totals with SUM() OVER. Task: cumulative revenue by day.

- **Day 19**

  LAG and LEAD. Task: month-on-month revenue growth %.

- **Day 20**

  Deduplication with ROW_NUMBER. Task: keep the latest row per customer.

- **Day 21**

  Revision. 10 window function questions.

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Week 4: Days 22 to 30

Interview prep and one project to show.

Days 22-23

Classic questions: second highest salary, duplicates, employee earning more than manager.

Days 24-25

Business metrics: retention, repeat customers, conversion by funnel step.

Days 26-27

Project: 8 business questions on one dataset, answered in SQL, with a short write-up.

Day 28

Put the project on GitHub with a README showing each question and insight.

Day 29

Timed practice: 5 medium questions in 60 minutes.

Day 30

Mock interview. Explain your thinking out loud while solving.

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Job-ready means you can do this

Check these on day 30. If you can, start applying.

- **Write joins without checking syntax**
  Including LEFT JOIN with IS NULL.
- **Use GROUP BY with HAVING correctly**
  And explain the difference from WHERE.
- **Solve top N per group**
  With DENSE_RANK in a subquery or CTE.
- **Calculate growth and running totals**
  With LAG and SUM() OVER.
- **Explain one project end to end**
  The business question, your queries and what you found.

If you miss a day, do not double up. Move the plan by one day. Consistency matters more than speed.

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